

Skills for Life

Rules and tools

**ESOL
Entry 2**

Rules and tools

These supplementary materials are a series of reference sheets designed to support and clarify some of the language and skills objectives addressed in the ESOL Skills for Life Entry 2 learner materials. They are available for the teacher to download and distribute to the learner as required .

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1 Present simple

E2 Unit 1 ◀

Where do your parents live? ⇒ They live in Foxhill road.

What does Mr Singh do? ⇒ He works at the local advice centre.

Use

- You often use the present simple tense to talk about things that are always true.
*They **have** two daughters.*
*She **comes** from India.*
- You also use it to talk about things you do regularly.

*She **watches** TV every day.*
*I **look after** my sister's children on Saturday afternoons.*
*He never **drinks** alcohol.*

Form

Positive	I / you / we / they work . He / she / it works .
Negative	I / you / we / they don't (do not) work . He / she doesn't (does not) work .
Question	Do I / you / we / they work ? Does he / she work ?

- You add -s to the verb with *he*, *she* and *it*.
*She **works** very hard.*
- You make a question with **does** for *he*, *she* and *it*.
- For short answers you use the pronoun and *do*, *don't*, *does* and *doesn't*.
Does your wife work? ⇒ Yes, **she does**.
Do your children go to the Kingsland school? ⇒ No, **they don't**.

2 Adverbs of frequency

E2 Unit 1 ◀◀

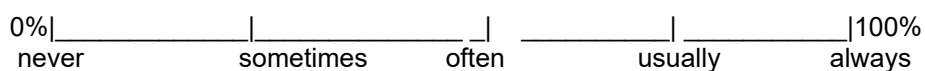
The buses **never** come on time .

I **often** get to work late.

I'm **never** late for work.

Use

- You use adverbs of frequency to say how often things happen.



*I don't **often** go to the cinema.*

*Mr Makmood **always** goes to the mosque on Fridays.*

*She's **never** late.*

Form

- The adverb of frequency usually just goes before the verb.

*I **always** leave work early on Fridays.*

*Do you **often** watch football on TV?*

- With the verb *be* the adverb of frequency usually goes just after the verb.

*He's **always** at home on Sundays.*

3 Present continuous

E2 Unit 1, Unit 6◀◀

What are you doing tomorrow?

We aren't doing anything special.

I'm working all day.

My neighbour is coming for lunch.

They're getting married in

June.

Use

You use the present continuous tense to talk about definite future plans.

Form

- You form the present continuous with *be* and the *-ing* form of the verb.

Positive	I'm (am) working. He/ she's (is) working. You/ we/ they're (are) working.
Negative	I'm (am) not working. He / she isn't (is not) working. We/ you /they aren't (are not)working.
Question	Am I working? Is he/ she working? Are you/ we / they working?

- You often use a future time marker with the present continuous.

*I'm buying a sofa **tomorrow**.*

*I'm going to a Dawali party **next week**.*

*What time are you leaving **on Friday**?*

- When you speak you usually use short forms, e.g.

<i>I am seeing</i>	⇒	<i>I'm seeing</i>
<i>You are going</i>	⇒	<i>You're going</i>
<i>We are leaving</i>	⇒	<i>We're leaving</i>
<i>They are buying</i>	⇒	<i>They're buying</i>
<i>She is staying</i>	⇒	<i>She's staying</i>
<i>He is arriving</i>	⇒	<i>He's arriving</i>
<i>It is raining</i>	⇒	<i>It's raining</i>

4 Adjectives

E2 Unit 1, Unit 5◀◀

What did you buy?

A small grey leather sofa.



Form

- An **Adjectives** tell you more about people and things.

adjective

He's a **tall** man.

adjective

The road is **busy**.

- Usually adjectives go before the noun, not after it.

bright colours.

new clothes .

- Adjectives can go after the verb *be* and *feel*.

His clothes are **new**.

I feel **tired**.

- When you use two more adjectives they usually go in this order.

opinion	size	age	colour	material	Noun
		new	black	linen	jacket
beautiful			blue		sari
	big	new			car
	small		grey	leather	sofa
	big		red	velvet	cushions

He bought a **new black linen** jacket.

She 's wearing a **beautiful blue** sari.

She's got a **big new** car.

He I bought a **small grey leather** sofa, with **big red velvet** cushions.

- Use **and** for more than one colour.

I bought blue **and** white cotton shirt.

Common errors

- The adjective must go before the noun.

I've got a jacket new. ✗ = I've got a new jacket ✓

- adjectives of opinion must go before age

It's an old horrible table. ✗ = It's a horrible old table. ✓

- Adjectives of colour must go before material

There are some cotton blue curtains. ✗ = There are some blue cotton curtains. ✓

5 Past simple 1

E2 Unit 2, Unit 7 ◀◀

I didn't drive there.

We took the train It was very quick.

Use

- You use the simple past tense to talk about completed past actions.

I *came* to England in 1997.

I *didn't have* a job at first.

Form

positive	I / he / she/ it	worked	yesterday?
	We / you / they	went	last week

negative	I / he / she/ it	didn't (did not) work	yesterday?
	We / you / they	didn't (did not) go	last week?

- To form the regular past simple, you add **-ed** to the verb stem. (or **d** for verbs which end in **e**):

<i>work</i>	worked	<i>start</i>	started
<i>arrive</i>	arrived	<i>visit</i>	visited

- Many other verbs have irregular forms.

<i>come</i>	came	<i>have</i>	had
<i>go</i>	went	<i>take</i>	took

- For regular and irregular verbs the form is the same with all pronouns: I / you/ he/ she/ we/ they.

I **came** her in 1999.

We **came** here last year.

- To form the negative, you put *did not* before the verb stem.

I **didn't** (did not) **go** to work yesterday.

Cristina **didn't** (did not) **have** lunch.

- You often use these time markers with the simple past.

yesterday, last Monday, last week, last month, 2 months ago, last year, 10 years ago, in 1995, when I was a 18

6 Past simple 2

E2 Unit 2, Unit 7 ◀◀

When did you get up?

What time did you arrive at work?

Form

question	Did I / he / she/ it	work	yesterday?
	Did we / you / they	go	last week?

- Use **did** to make questions in the past.
*Did she **go** to college yesterday?*
*What time **did** they **get up**?*
*How **did** you **get** to work?*

Common errors

- Did you ~~bought~~ anything? ✗ = Did you **buy** anything? ✓*

Be in the past

Form

positive	I / he / she/ it was late. You/ we / they were late.
negative	I / he / she/ it wasn't (was not) late. You/ we / they weren't (were not) late.
question	Was I / he / she/ late? Were you/ we / they late?

present

*We **are** very tired to day.*

*The match **isn't** very interesting . ⇒*

Is Tom at home today? ⇒

past

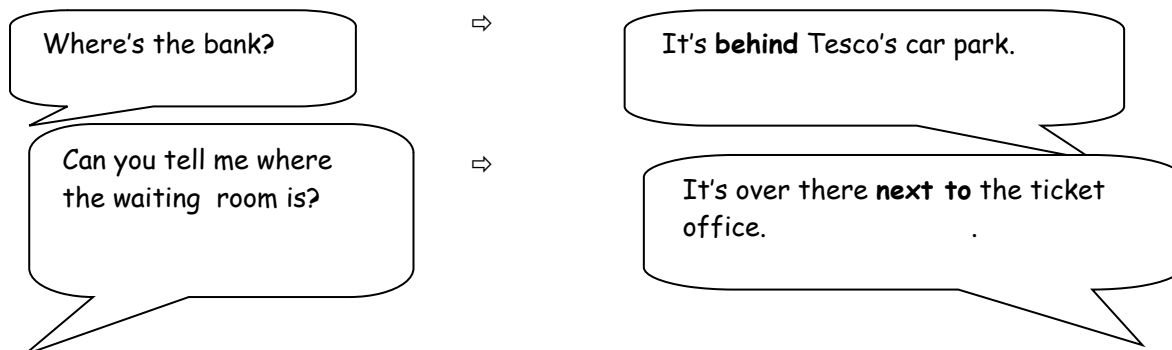
⇒ *We **were** very tired yesterday .*

*The match **wasn't** (was not) very interesting.*

***Was** Tom at home yesterday?*

7 Prepositions of place

E2 Unit 3



Use

- You use the preposition *in* for street names.
*The health centre's **in** Green Road.*
- You use prepositions of place to say where things are.
*The bank's **next to** the supermarket.*
*My house is **at the end of** Riverside Road.*
*The library **opposite** the town hall.*

Meaning

next to



*The bank is **next to** the post office.*

behind



*The car park's **behind** the supermarket.*

in front of



*The bus stop's **in front of** the post office.*

opposite



*The car park entrance is **opposite** an Indian restaurant.*

on the left



on the right



*There's a newsagent's **on the left** and a bicycle shop **on the right**.*

- Some prepositions of place have more than one word.
in front of, next to, on the right/left

Common errors

*It's ~~opposite of~~ the bank ✗ = It's **opposite** the bank. ✓*

8 Imperatives

E2 Unit 3, Unit 5◀◀

How do I get from the station to your house?

Come out of the station and **turn** right. **Don't** **cross** the road. My street's the first street on the left.

Use

- You can use the imperative – just the verb – when you give directions in the street.
***Walk** along Queens street and **turn** left at the traffic lights.*
- You often use the imperative when you give instruction for using things.
***Put** the soap in the soap drawer. Then **set** the temperature control*
- You use a negative imperative - *don't + verb-* to tell people not to do something.
***Don't** **cross** the road.*
***Don't** **take** the first road on the left.*
***Don't** **put** too many clothes in the washing machine.*
- When you give instructions use sequence markers to show the order of steps.
***First**, open the door **Next**, put the clothes in. **Then**, put in the powder and set the program. **Finally**, press the start button.*

***First** come out of the station and turn right. Walk to the end of the road. **Then** turn right, you'll see the supermarket on the left.*

9 Question words

E2 Unit 3◀◀

What's the best way to get to Bristol?

By train.

When's the next train?

At 14.25.

How much does it cost?

£16 return.

Use

- You often use *Wh-* questions to ask for travel information. *Wh-* questions start with words like: *What, Where, When, Which, Why,*

Use *what* for things

What's the best way to get to Hull? ⇨ *There's a good train service.*

Use *when* for times

When does the first train leave? ⇨ *At 7.45 ?*

Also use *what time* for times

What time's the next train to Hull? ⇨ *At 8.15.*

Use *why* for explanations

Why does it take so long ? ⇨ *You have to change at Swindon.*

Use *where* for places

Where can I buy a ticket? ⇨ *At the ticket office ,over there.*

Use *which + noun* for things

Which platform is it? ⇨ *Platform 8.*

- You can also use questions beginning with *how*.

Use *how far* for distances

How far is it to Hull? ⇨ *About 30 miles.*

Use *how much* for cost

How much does it cost? ⇨ *£15 return.*

Use *how long* for length of time

How long does it take? ⇨ *About an hour.*

- When you ask for information, you usually add *please*.
How much is it to Hull, please?
Which platform is, please?

10 Can ...? or could...?

E2 Unit 3

Could you give me change for the ticket machine, please?

Can I have a return to Birmingham, please?

Could you take me to the station, please?

I'm afraid I can't. I don't have any change.

Certainly. That's £10 please.

Yes, of course. What time does the train arrive?

Use

- You often use *Can I...?* or *Could I...?* when you ask for something.
Can I have a cup of coffee, please?
Could I have a single to Glasgow, please?
- You use *Can you...?* or *Could you...?* when you make requests.
Can you help me with my bags, please?
Could you stop by the taxi rank, please?

Form

Question	Can I have a return ticket? Could I have a sandwich?
----------	---

Question	Can you meet me at the station? Could you help me with my bags?
----------	--

- When you ask for things you usually add, *please*.
Could I have a return ticket, please?
- You often say *here you are* when we give somebody the thing they want.
Can I have a timetable, please? ⇒ *Yes, here you are.*
- When you say yes to a request, you say *yes, of course*.
Can you meet me at the station, please? ⇒ *Yes, of course / no problem.*
- When you say no to a request, you can say *I'm afraid I can't* and give a reason.
Could you post this for me? ⇒ *I'm afraid, I can't. I'm really busy.*

Does Amina have to wear a uniform?

Yes, all the children have to wear a uniform.

What time does school start?

At 9 o'clock, but you must be in your classroom at 8:45.

Do I have to fill in the form?

Yes, everybody has to complete it.

Uses

You use *must* and *have to* to talk about rules and things that are necessary.

Form

positive	I / we/ you they must go. I / we/ you they have to go. He / she must go. He / she has to go.
----------	---

question	Must I / we / you / they go? Do I / we. you/ they have to go? Must he she go? Does he/ she have to go?
----------	---

- When you talk about rules you can use *must* or *have to*.
*Children **must** start school when they are five.*
*Children **have to** start school when they are five.*
- When you talk about something which you think is necessary, you use *must*.
*I **must** work harder.*
*He **must** clean his car. It's very dirty.*
- When you ask about rules it more usual to use *Do ... have to ...?* than *Must ...?*
*Do I **have to** take my passport?*
- The past of *must* and *have to* is *had to*.
*I **had to** go to a parents' evening last week.*

Common errors

- You don't add an s to *must* for *he* and *she*.
*She ~~musts~~ do all her homework. ✗ = He **must** do all her homework. ✓*
- You don't use *to* after *must*.
*She ~~must to~~ improve her spelling. ✗ = She **must improve** her spelling. ✓*

12 *Mustn't* and *don't have to*

E2 Unit 3 ◀◀

Can I wear my trainers to school?

No! You *mustn't* wear trainers to school.

You must fill in an application form for your library card, but you *don't have to* do it today.

Use

Mustn't and *don't have to* have different meanings.

- You use *mustn't* when there is rule that tells you not to do something.
You mustn't smoke in the bus. Look there's a no smoking sign.
- You use *don't have to* when you want to say something is not necessary.
You must fill in the application, but you *don't have to* do it now (you can if you want, but it's not necessary.)

Form

negative	I / you. we/ they <i>mustn't</i> (must not) eat it. He/ she <i>mustn't</i> (must not) use it.
----------	---

negative	I / you / we / they <i>don't</i> (don't) have to eat it He/ she <i>doesn't</i> (does not) have to eat it.
----------	--

- When you speak you normally use the short form *mustn't*.
*You **mustn't** park on double yellow lines.*

13 Have/has got**E2 Unit 3** ◀◀

Which TV do you like?

I like those two, they've got nice big screens.

What about that one?

No. It hasn't got a very big screen.

Has it got a guarantee?

Yes. It's got a five year guarantee.

Use

- You use *have/has got* when you talk about a product's features - the special things about the product.

Form

positive	It's (has) got text messaging. They've (have) got text messaging.
negative	It hasn't (has not) got picture messaging. They haven't (have not got) picture messaging.
question	Has it got voice dialling? Have they got voice dialling?

Common errors

- It is got e-mail. ✗ = It has got e-mail. ✓

14 Conjunctions

E2 Unit 5, Unit 7 ◀◀

I've got family in the UK
and in Pakistan.

We moved to Hull because my wife
got a new job.

I work very long hours, but the
pay is bad.

I want to speak better English so I'm
studying ESOL at college.

General meaning

Conjunctions are words like *and*, *because*, *but*, and *so*. You use them to join sentences together.

Use

- You use *and* to add information.

*In my job I answer the phone **and** I meet customers.*

- You use *but* to introduce a difference.

In my last job I didn't use a computer but now I use one every day.

- You use *because* to introduce a reason

*She can only work part-time **because** she has small children.*

- You use *so* to introduce a result.

*She has small children **so** she can only work part-time.*

Form

- You can use *and* to join sentences and shorter phrases. Remember when you use *and*, you don't need to repeat unnecessary words.

*I went to the shop with my friend **and** we bought a mobile phone.*

*We went to three shops **and** (we) looked at a lot of phones.*

*We looked in Dixons **and** (we looked in) the Orange shop.*

- You can put *because* at the beginning of the sentence or between the two parts of the sentence.

*I didn't go to my computer class **because** I was ill.*

***Because** I was ill, I didn't go to my computer class.*

15 Verb + ing

E2 Unit 6, Unit 8

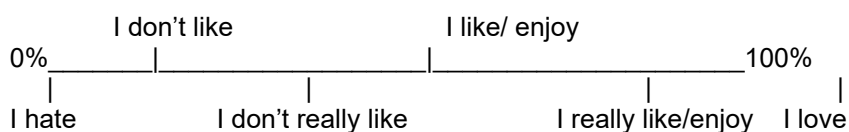
I hate getting up early in winter.

I really like spending time with my family at the weekend.

Ahmed loves playing football.

Use

- You use the verb + *ing* when you talk about liking or disliking something.



*I **don't like** working in the office all the time.*

*Do you **enjoy** studying English?*

- You can also use the verb *enjoy* + *ing* when you like doing something.

*I like **meeting** new people.*

or

*I enjoy **meeting** new people.*

- When you use the phrase *be good at*, you follow it with a noun or the *verb+ing*.

I'm not very good at sport.

*I'm very good at **working** with my hands.*

*He's not very good at **learning** languages.*

- When you use the verb *mind*, you also follow it with verb + *ing*

*I don't **mind** working late some evenings.*

16 Comparisons

E2 Unit 7 ◀◀

People are more friendly in my country than they are here.

It's easier to find work in big towns than in the countryside.

I think small towns are safer than big cities.

Use

- You use the comparative when you compare two things, places or people.

*This phone is **more expensive than** that one.*

*Samira is **younger than** Hamid.*

- You often use comparatives to talk about changes.

*The air is **a lot cleaner now**.*

*It's **easier to find jobs in the south**.*

Form

- You add **-er** to make the comparative of short adjectives (one syllable words).

*cheap- **cheaper***

*old- **older***

*dirty **dirtier***

*safe **safer***

- You put **more** in front of the adjective for long adjectives (e.g. adjectives with more than two syllables and most adjectives with two syllables).

more expensive

more beautiful

more dangerous

more exciting

- Some adjectives have an irregular comparative form.

*good = **better***

*far = **farther/further***

*bad = **worse***

- You put **than** before the second thing you are comparing.

*In my country food was cheaper **than** in the UK.*

Common errors

- With short adjectives you don't use more.

Wages were ~~more~~ lower in my country. ✗ = Wages were lower in my country. ✓

- You use **than** after a comparative adjective not **that**.

*This job is harder ~~that~~ my old job. ✗ = This job is harder **than** my old job. ✓*

— The comparative of bad is irregular.

17 Can

E2 Unit 8 ◀◀

I can use a computer.

I can speak good English but I can't write it well.

Can you use a till?

He cannot drive because he hasn't got licence.

Use

_ You use *can* to talk about general skills and abilities.

Form

positive	I / we/ you they can drive. He / she can drive.
negative	I / we/ you they can't (cannot) drive. He / she can't (cannot) drive.
question	Can I / we / you / they drive? Can he / she drive?

- Can is the same for all the pronouns.

*She **can** type.*

*I **can** use a computer.*

- You use *could* to talk about general ability in the past.

*I **could** swim well when I was five.*

*Before I came to England I **couldn't** speak English.*

- When you speak or write informally you normally use *can't*.
- When you write more formally you normally use *cannot*.

Common errors

- You don't use *to* with *can*.

I can ~~to~~ speak French. ✖ = I can speak French. ✓

- You never use *do* or *does* in questions with *can*.

Do you can drive? ✖ = Can you drive? ✓

18 Reading skills

Skimming

Skimming means:

Looking at: the beginnings or ends of paragraphs, sentences, words or headings to give you a **general idea** about what you are reading

- reading something quickly
- not reading every word
- not using a dictionary

What kind of text do you skim read?

- leaflets
- newspaper articles
- posters

Scanning

Scanning means:

Looking at: sentences, words, headings or numbers to find **important information**.

- reading something quickly
- not reading every word
- not using a dictionary

What kind of text do you scan?

- a telephone book
- an instruction booklet
- a newspaper article leaflet or poster for information like a date, a time or about important events

Detailed reading

Detailed reading means:

- Reading the text **carefully** because you want to understand everything, using a dictionary

What kind of text do you read in detail?

- a letter from the bank
- a recipe
- instructions

19 Writing skills

Sentences

Sentence checklist. A sentence must:

- begin with a capital letter and end with a full stop.
- have a verb.
- have a subject (the subject is **what** or **who** the sentence is about).
- make sense.

Look at some common mistakes and corrections:

- There are no full stops.

My name is Shaheeda Parveen I came to the UK in 1998 ✖ =
My name is Shaheeda Parveen. I came to the UK in 1990. ✓

- There is no verb.
- I very good at English. ✖ = I **am** very good at English. ✓

- There is no subject.
- Live in Manchester. ✖ = **I** live in Manchester. ✓

This does not make sense. = I like very much. ✖ =
I like **Manchester** very much. ✓

Capital letters

You use capital letters for:

- The names of people or places :
Tony **B**lair lives in **L**ondon.

- Nationalities and languages:
*She is from **A**lgeria and she speaks **A**rabic.*

- Days of the week and months:
I arrived on a **M**onday in **S**eptember.

- Words which stand for me or myself:
When **I** came to the UK **I** felt cold.

- Brand and company names:
I bought some **N**ike trainers from **S**portsworld.

20 Writing skills (continued)

Joining parts of a sentence

We use conjunctions like **and**, **but**, **because** and **so** to link two parts of a sentence.

- **Adding information (+ +)**

We use **and** to add more information to the first part of a sentence:

I study maths **and** English .

- **Making a contrast (+ -)**

We use **but** to show how the second part of the sentence is different from the first:

I bought a mobile phone from your shop **but** it doesn't work properly.

- **Giving a reason (?)**

We use **because** to give the reason for the first part of the sentence:

He came to the UK **because** there was trouble in his country.

- **Giving a result (=)**

We use **so** to give the result of the first part of the sentence:

I am a nurse **so** I work long hours.

21 Listening skills

Prediction

Prediction helps you to understand what you are going to listen to. Prediction means: **before** you listen, thinking about:

- why you are listening
- what the situation is
- who is speaking
- what people are going to say.

Listening for gist

Listening for gist means:

- listening for a **general** idea of what someone is saying
- not listening to every word.
- listening for stressed words
- listening for intonation.

When do you listen for gist?

- face to face conversations
- telephone conversations
- radio and TV programmes
- the first time you listen to a tape in class.

Listening for detail

- listening **carefully** for important information
- listening for stressed words
- listening for repeated words
- listening for the past, present or future tenses
- checking you understand in a conversation.

When do you listen for detail?

- instructions
- directions
- explanations
- announcements
- the second time you listen to a tape in class.

- Remember! The most important thing about listening: relax! – don't try to understand everything.

22 Learning new words

- First think about how you learn and remember new words. What kind of words do you remember? What kind do you forget?
- Try keeping a vocabulary notebook. Remembering new words is more than just writing a translation. Look at the different ways of making a record of new words. Think about which way suits you.
 - Memory maps: help you to remember words for situations or topics.
 - Pictures: help you remember words by thinking about what they look like.:
 - Marking the grammar V (verb) A (adjective) N (noun) It can help you help you remember where and how to use the word in a sentence:

economise	(V)
economy	(N)
economical	(A)

Example sentences can help you remember when and how to use a word and what words go with it:

*I must **economise**, I'm spending too much money.*

*The Government is trying to improve the **economy**.*

*Mobile phones are not very **economical**. Phone calls cost than with traditional phones.*

23 Spelling rules

Regular verb endings for the past simple

When you form the simple past for regular verb, you add **-ed**, e.g. *start - started* but sometimes the spelling changes.

- When the verb ends in **e**, you just add **d**.
arrive - arrived close - closed live - lived

*I **lived** in Somalia until I was 10.*

- When the verb ends in a consonant + **y**, the **y** changes to **ied**.
*cry - **cried** try - **tried** study - **studied***

*He **studied** law in his country.*

- When you add **-ed** to a verb ending in one vowel and one consonant, you double the consonant.

*chat - **chatted** grab - **grabbed** plan - **planned***

*We **planned** a big party for his birthday.*

Verb + ing with the *present continuous*

When you form the present continuous, you add **-ing** to the verb, e.g. *visit - visiting* but sometimes the spelling changes.

- with verbs which end in **e**, you drop the final **e**:

*come **coming***
*write **writing***

*My aunt is **coming** to visit next week.*

- When the verb ends in 1 vowel and 1 consonant, you double the final consonant.

*get **getting***
*stop **stopping***

*I'm **getting** a new video at the weekend.*

Comparatives

When you form the comparative of short adjectives you add **er**, e.g. *fast - faster*, but sometimes the spelling changes.

- When the adjective ends in **e**, you just add **r**:

*large **larger***
*nice **nicer***

*Small towns are **nicer** than big cities.*

- When the adjective ends in **y**, you add **ier**:

*happy - **happier***
*friendly - **friendlier***

*In Scotland people were **friendlier** than in England.*

- When the adjective end in a vowel and a consonant, you double the consonant:

ESOL ENTRY 2

big bigger hot hotter

Rules and tools

*In Somalia the summers are **hotter** than Britain.*